

AQR-IREA WORKSHOP

on

Firms and Gender Inequality

October 8, 2026 – Room 2019 (Av. Diagonal, 696)

09:00 – 09:15	Registration and welcome
Session 1 · Beliefs, appreciation, and gender at work	
09:15 – 10:00	Olle Folke (Stockholm Institute of Transition Economics) <i>Workplace Sex Composition and Appreciation at Work</i> (with Johanna Rickne) Discussant: Judit Vall (UB & IEB)
10:00 – 10:45	Anne Ardila Brenøe (University of Zurich) <i>Backlash from Gender Equality</i> (with Michela Carlana, Stefan Wolter, and Thea Zöllner) Discussant: Perihan Saygin (UAB)
10:45 – 11:15	Coffee break
Session 2 · Workplace flexibility, family policies, and the motherhood penalty	
11:15 – 12:00	Arizo Karimi (Uppsala University) <i>Parenthood, Family Friendly Firms, and Gender Gaps in Early Work Careers</i> (with V. Joseph Hotz and Per Johansson) Discussant: Lidia Farré (IAE-CSIC & BSE)
12:00 – 12:45	Salvatore Lattanzio (Bank of Italy) <i>Workplace Flexibility and the Motherhood Penalty: Evidence from the Diffusion of Remote Work</i> (with Gaetano Basso, Maria De Paola and Matteo Paradisi) Discussant: Cristina Bellés-Obrero (IAE-CSIC & BSE)
12:45 – 13:30	Claudia Hupkau (CUNEF) <i>When Paternity Leave Catches Up: Impact on Gender Equality and Labour Market Outcomes</i> (with Lidia Farré, Libertad González, and Jenifer Ruiz-Valenzuela) Discussant: Jaime Millán-Quijano (UB & IEB)
13:30 – 14:30	Lunch
Session 3 · Gender gaps from the bottom to the top	
14:30 – 15:15	Hannah Illing (Mercator School of Management, University of Duisburg-Essen) <i>The Gender Gap in Entry Wages: Evidence from Exogenous Vacancies</i> (with Hanna Schwank and Linh Tô) Discussant: Ana Costa-Ramón (University of Zurich)
15:15 – 16:00	Anna Thoreson (Reykjavik University) <i>Firm Performance and Female CEO Appointments</i> (with Ana Costa-Ramón, Lena Hensvik, and Ana Rodríguez-González) Discussant: Caroline Coly (UB & IEB)
16:00 – 16:30	Coffee break

Session 4 · Firms and paternity leave**16:30 – 17:15****Luis Guirola** (UB & AQR-IREA)*Statistical Discrimination and Paternity Leave* (with Libertad González)Discussant: **Rosa Ferrer** (UPF & BSE)**17:15 – 18:00****Libertad González** (UPF & BSE)*Peer Effects in Paternity Leave* (with Emma Fantappiè, Lúdia Farré, and Luis Guirola)Discussant: **Anastasia Terskaya** (UB & IEB)

The workshop is organized by the AQR-IREA research group at the Universitat de Barcelona and funded by AQR and the Spanish Ministry of Science, Innovation, and Universities; project no. PID2023-146073NB-I00

Workshop organizers

- **Luis Guirola** (UB and AQR-IREA)
- **Ana Rodríguez-González** (UB and AQR-IREA)

If interested in attending, please contact anarodriguezgonzalez@ub.edu